PANJAB UNIVERSITY, CHANDIGARH-160014 (INDIA)
(Estd. under the Panjab University Act VII of 1947-enacted by the Govt. of India)

FACULTY OF ARTS

SYLLABI

FOR

M.A. Philosophy *and* M.A. Philosophy with Research Two Year Programme

(According to NEP)

1st Semester for Examinations 2026- 2027

NATIONAL EDUCATION POLICY (NEP) 2020 BASED TEMPLATE TO AWARD M.A./M.A.WITH RESEARCH IN – PHILOSOPHY TWO YEAR DEGREE

Table 1 M.A. Philosophy						Table 2 M.A. Philosophy with Research					
Sem	**Level of Course**	**Course Code**	**Course Name**	**Credits**	**Total Credits**	**Sem**	**Level of Course**	**Course Code**	**Course Name**	**Credits**	**Total Credits**
I	L-400	MAPHILDSC-101	Nature, Problems and Methods of Philosophy	4	20	I	L-450	MAPHILDSC-101	Nature, Problems and Methods of Philosophy	4	20
		MAPHILDSC-102	Classical Indian Metaphysics	4				MAPHILDSC-102	Classical Indian Metaphysics	4	
		MAPHILDSC-103	Greek Philosophy	4				MAPHILDSC-103	Greek Philosophy	4	
		MAPHILDSC-104	Logic	4				MAPHILDSC-104	Logic	4	
		MAPHILDSE-105(*)	Any one of the following: 105 (1)Vedanta 105 (2) Plato & Aristotle 105 (3)Social and Political Philosophy 105 (4)Philosophy of Science	4				MAPHILDSE-105(*)	Any one of the following: 105 (1)Vedanta 105 (2) Plato & Aristotle 105 (3)Social and Political Philosophy 105 (4)Philosophy of Science	4	

M.A. Philosophy Syllabus NEP 2020

MAPHILDSC-101 Nature, Problems and Methods of Philosophy

Course Code: MAPHILDSC-101
Credits:4
Contact Hours:60
Scheme: Theory: 80 Marks, Internal Assessment: 20 Marks

Course Objectives

1. To introduce students to the nature, scope, and methods of philosophical inquiry in both Western and Indian traditions.
2. To familiarise learners with major philosophical approaches, including analytic, dialectical, phenomenological, hermeneutic, comparative, and pramāṇa-based methods.
3. To develop a critical understanding of foundational issues in metaphysics, epistemology, and axiology.
4. To situate philosophy in relation to science, religion, and common sense for interdisciplinary reflection.
5. To cultivate skills in conceptual analysis, argument evaluation, and philosophical writing through engagement with classical and contemporary texts.

Learning Outcomes

1. Explain the defining features and methods of philosophical inquiry.
2. Analyse major debates in metaphysics and epistemology.
3. Critically evaluate ethical, social-political, and aesthetic theories, including the Indian theory of *rasa*.
4. Interpret and engage rigorously with primary philosophical texts.
5. Construct clear, coherent, and well-reasoned philosophical arguments.
6. Apply philosophical methods to contemporary intellectual and social issues.
7. Develop a comparative philosophical perspective integrating Indian and Western traditions.
8. Demonstrate enhanced disciplinary knowledge, critical thinking, ethical awareness, research aptitude, and effective academic communication.

Pedagogy of Course Work

1. The course follows a workshop-oriented, practice-driven pedagogical model that emphasises learning by doing.
2. Classroom engagement prioritises guided writing exercises, peer review, group discussions, and supervised research activities over lecture-based delivery.
3. Students progressively develop dissertation components such as a research question, annotated bibliography, literature review, and research proposal through staged assignments with continuous feedback.

4. Close textual engagement is integrated with training in analytical writing, argument mapping, and conceptual clarification.
5. The pedagogy emphasises mentorship, collaboration, and research communication through seminar-style presentations and structured peer critique.
6. Students receive hands-on training in digital research tools, academic databases, and citation management practices.
7. Iterative drafting and revision processes cultivate precision, coherence, and intellectual independence.
8. The course prepares students to undertake dissertation research and to contribute to academic forums such as conferences and publications.

Instructions for Paper Setters and Candidates

I. The theory paper shall carry 80 marks, and 20 marks shall be for internal assessment.
II. For private candidates who have not undergone internal assessment, theory marks will be proportionately increased to the maximum marks of the paper. The paper setter must include this note in the question paper.
III. The question paper shall contain 9 questions in total. Question 1 is compulsory, containing 15 short-answer type questions spread over the entire syllabus. Candidate is required to answer any 10 out of these 15, in about 25–30 words each. These shall carry 2 marks each (Total: 20 marks). The remaining paper shall consist of 4 Units. Each Unit will contain two questions with internal choice, with each having a weightage of 15 marks. Candidates must attempt one question from each Unit.

Course Content

Unit I – Nature and Methods of Philosophy (20 Hours)

1. Nature, scope, and characteristics of philosophical inquiry
2. Philosophy in relation to science, religion, and common sense
3. Major philosophical methods: analytic, dialectical, phenomenological, hermeneutic, and comparative approaches
4. Methods in Indian philosophy: pramāṇa theory, debate traditions, and textual interpretation

Unit II – Metaphysics: Theories of Reality (20 Hours)

1. Ontology: being, substance, universals and particulars
2. Identity, change, persistence, and personal identity
3. Causation, determinism, and freedom
4. Mind–body problem and theories of consciousness

Unit III – Epistemology: Knowledge and Justification (20 Hours)

1. Nature and definition of knowledge; belief, truth, and justification
2. Sources of knowledge: perception, inference, memory, testimony
3. Skepticism and responses to skepticism
4. Indian epistemology: pramāṇas and theories of valid cognition

Unit IV – Axiology: Value Theory (Ethics, Social-Political Thought, Aesthetics) (20 Hours)

1. Nature of value and major approaches in normative ethics
2. Meta-ethical theories: realism, relativism, emotivism
3. Justice, rights, liberty, and equality in social and political philosophy
4. Aesthetic experience, beauty, art, and rasa theory in Indian aesthetics

Reading List

Essential Readings

Russell, B. (1912). *The problems of philosophy*.Oxford University Press.

Plato. (2002). *Five dialogues* (G. M. A. Grube& J. M. Cooper, Trans.). Hackett Publishing. (Original work published ca. 380 BCE)

Aristotle. (1998). *Metaphysics* (H. Tredennick& G. C. Armstrong, Trans.).Harvard University Press. (Original work published ca. 350 BCE)

Aristotle. (2004). *Nicomachean ethics* (R. Crisp, Trans.).Cambridge University Press. (Original work published ca. 340 BCE)

Descartes, R. (1996). *Meditations on first philosophy* (J. Cottingham, Trans.).Cambridge University Press. (Original work published 1641)

Kant, I. (2012). *Groundwork of the metaphysics of morals* (M. Gregor& J. Timmermann, Trans.).Cambridge University Press. (Original work published 1785)

Mill, J. S. (2001). *Utilitarianism*. Hackett Publishing. (Original work published 1861)

Rawls, J. (1999). *A theory of justice* (Rev. ed.). Harvard University Press. (Original work published 1971)

Gettier, E. L. (1963). Is justified true belief knowledge? *Analysis, 23*(6), 121–123. https://doi.org/10.1093/analys/23.6.121

Radhakrishnan, S. (Ed. & Trans.). (1953). *The principal Upanishads*. HarperCollins.

Matilal, B. K. (1986). *Perception: An essay on classical Indian theories of knowledge*. Oxford University Press.*(For Nyāya, Dignāga, Dharmakīrti selections)*

Ghosh, M. (Trans.). (1951). *TheNāṭyaśāstra of Bharata Muni* (Vol. 1). Asiatic Society.

Suggested Readings

Blackburn, S. (2001).*Think: A compelling introduction to philosophy*. Oxford University Press.

Nagel, T. (1987).*What does it all mean? A very short introduction to philosophy*.Oxford University Press.

Grayling, A. C. (1998).*Philosophy: A very short introduction*. Oxford University Press.

Quine, W. V. O. (1948). On what there is. *Review of Metaphysics, 2*(5), 21–38.

Lewis, D. (1986). *On the plurality of worlds*. Blackwell.

Sosa, E. (1991). *Knowledge in perspective: Selected essays in epistemology*. Cambridge University Press.

Nussbaum, M. C. (2001). *Upheavals of thought: The intelligence of emotions*. Cambridge University Press.

Radhakrishnan, S. (2008).*Indian philosophy* (Vols. 1–2).Oxford University Press. (Original work published 1923–1927)

Coomaraswamy, A. K. (1956). *The transformation of nature in art*.Dover Publications. (Original work published 1934)

MAPHILDSC-102: Classical Indian Metaphysics

Course Code: MAPHILDSC-102
Credits:4
Level: M.A. Philosophy
Contact Hours:60
Scheme: Theory: 80 Marks, Internal Assessment: 20 Marks

Course Objectives

1. To cultivate a deep and systematic understanding of the classical metaphysical foundations of Indian philosophy.
2. To acquaint students with Darśana as a comprehensive worldview integrating metaphysical, ethical, epistemological, and soteriological concerns.
3. To introduce and analyse key metaphysical concepts such as Ātman, Brahman, Karma, Prakṛti, and Puruṣa.
4. To develop an appreciation of Indian metaphysics as a sustained reflection on reality, consciousness, causation, and liberation.
5. To foster critical and comparative philosophical competence through the study of Vedānta, Sāṃkhya, Buddhism, Jainism, and Cārvāka.
6. To sharpen interpretive skills for analysing metaphysical doctrines within their doctrinal and historical contexts.
7. To emphasise conceptual clarity, textual sensitivity, and rational justification in the study of Indian philosophy.
8. To prepare students for advanced study and research in classical Indian metaphysics.

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Demonstrate a systematic understanding of the core metaphysical doctrines of classical Indian philosophical systems.
2. Critically analyse concepts such as self, reality, causation, and liberation across different darśanic frameworks.
3. Interpret primary philosophical texts with conceptual clarity and historical awareness.
4. Compare orthodox and heterodox metaphysical positions and evaluate their philosophical implications.
5. Construct and articulate reasoned arguments on metaphysical issues from Indian philosophical perspectives.
6. Recognise the continuing relevance of Indian metaphysical thought within broader philosophical discourse.

Pedagogy of the Course

1. The course follows a text-centered and concept-driven pedagogical approach grounded in close reading of classical sources.

2. Classroom teaching integrates lectures with focused conceptual discussions on key metaphysical themes.
3. Students engage directly with primary texts to analyse arguments, trace conceptual developments, and understand inter-school debates.
4. Seminar discussions and short response assignments promote critical engagement and comparative reflection.
5. Internal assessments emphasise clarity of philosophical exposition and argumentative rigor.
6. The pedagogy aims to develop both historical understanding and advanced interpretive and analytical skills.
7. The course prepares students for independent research in Indian philosophy through sustained textual and conceptual training.

Instructions for Paper Setters and Candidates

I. The theory paper shall carry 80 marks, and 20 marks shall be for internal assessment.

II. For private candidates who have not undergone internal assessment, theory marks will be proportionately increased to the maximum marks of the paper. The paper setter must include this note in the question paper.

III. The question paper shall contain 9 questions in total. Question 1 is compulsory, containing 15 short-answer type questions spread over the entire syllabus. Candidate is required to answer any 10 out of these 15, in about 25–30 words each. These shall carry 2 marks each (Total: 20 marks). The remaining paper shall consist of 4 Units. Each Unit will contain two questions with internal choice, with each having a weightage of 15 marks. Candidates must attempt one question from each Unit.

Course Content

Unit I – Upaniṣadic and Vedāntic Metaphysics

1. Upaniṣadic worldview and metaphysical vision
2. Nature of Ātman and Brahman
3. States of consciousness: *Jāgrat, Svapna, Suṣupti,* and *Turīya* (MāṇḍūkyaUpaniṣad)
4. Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja: Brahman, Īśvara, Jīva; Māyā, Avidyā, and *Adhyāsa*

Unit II – Mīmāṃsā and Sāṃkhya Metaphysics

1. Dharma-lakṣaṇa in PūrvaMīmāṃsā
2. Karma theory: *Nitya, Naimittika, Kāmyā,* and *Niṣiddha*
3. Concept of *Apūrva* and its metaphysical significance

4. Nature of *Prakṛti* and *Puruṣa* and their relationship

Unit III – Causation, Evolution, and Liberation

1. Sāṃkhya theory of causation (*Satkāryavāda*)
2. Metaphysical implications of evolution (*Pariṇāma*)
3. Bondage and liberation in Sāṃkhya metaphysics
4. Comparative metaphysical analysis of causality and self

Unit IV – Heterodox Systems: Buddhism, Jainism, and Cārvāka

1. Buddhism: Four Noble Truths and *Pratītyasamutpāda*
2. *Vijñānavāda* and *Śūnyavāda*
3. Jain metaphysics: *Anekāntavāda, Syādvāda,* and *Saptabhaṅgī-naya*
4. Cārvāka materialism and *Svabhāvavāda*

Reading List

Essential Readings

Bijalwan, C. D. (1977). *Indian theory of knowledge based upon Jayanta'sNyāyamañjarī*. New Delhi: Heritage Publishers.
Hiriyanna, M. (1995).*Outlines of Indian philosophy*. Delhi: MotilalBanarsidass.
Radhakrishnan, S. (1991).*The Dhammapada*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
Shastri, D. N. (1976).*The philosophy of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika in its conflict with the Buddhist Dignāgaschool: A critique of Indian realism*. Delhi: BhartiyaVidyaPrakashan.
Vireswarananda, S. (1936).*Brahma Sūtras (Advaita interpretation)*. Kolkata: AdvaitaAshrama.
Upaniṣads.(1962). *Bṛhadāraṇyaka, Māṇḍūkya, and ChāndogyaUpaniṣads* (Trans. S. Radhakrishnan, S. Nikhilananda& R. E. Hume). New York: Dover Publications.

Suggested Readings

Chatterjee, C. (1978). *Nyāya theory of knowledge*. Calcutta: University of Calcutta.
Dasgupta, S. N. (1975). *A history of Indian philosophy* (Vols.I, III & V). Delhi: MotilalBanarsidass.
Radhakrishnan, S. (1971).*Indian philosophy* (Vols.I & II). London: George Allen &Unwin.

MAPHILDSC-103: Greek Philosophy

Course Code: MAPHILDSC-103
Credits:4
Level: M.A. Philosophy
Contact Hours:60
Examination Scheme: Theory: 80 Marks
Internal Assessment: 20 Marks

Course Objectives

1. To introduce students to the foundational problems of Western philosophy from Classical Greek thought to the medieval synthesis of faith and reason.
2. To examine core metaphysical and epistemological questions concerning reality, being and becoming, substance and change, the soul, causality, and knowledge.
3. To familiarise students with major thinkers including the Pre-Socratics, Socrates, Plato, Aristotle, and key medieval philosophers.
4. To trace the historical transition from mythological explanations to rational philosophical inquiry.
5. To analyse the integration of Greek philosophy with Christian theological frameworks in medieval thought.
6. To cultivate students' ability to critically engage with classical philosophical arguments and conceptual frameworks.
7. To develop historical awareness, analytical reasoning, and philosophical interpretation skills.
8. To prepare students for advanced study in modern philosophy through grounding in classical debates.

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Demonstrate knowledge of major metaphysical and epistemological issues in classical and medieval Western philosophy.
2. Explain key doctrines of Pre-Socratic thinkers, Socrates, Plato, Aristotle, and medieval philosophers.
3. Analyse philosophical arguments concerning being, knowledge, causality, and the soul.
4. Interpret selected primary philosophical texts with conceptual clarity.
5. Evaluate the relationship between faith and reason in medieval philosophical thought.
6. Identify continuities and transformations within the Western philosophical tradition.
7. Apply historical-philosophical understanding to subsequent developments in modern philosophy.

Pedagogy of the Course

1. The course adopts a historical-systematic pedagogical approach integrating chronological study with conceptual analysis.
2. Classroom instruction combines lectures introducing key ideas with guided discussions for conceptual clarification.
3. Primary texts and selected passages are used to familiarise students with classical philosophical reasoning.
4. Close reading exercises encourage careful interpretation of foundational philosophical works.
5. Internal assessments and short written responses promote critical reflection and analytical engagement.
6. Classroom dialogue fosters comparative understanding across thinkers and traditions.
7. The pedagogy ensures the development of both historical knowledge and higher-level philosophical skills.

Instructions for Paper Setters and Candidates

The theory paper shall carry 80 marks, and 20 marks shall be for internal assessment.

For private candidates who have not undergone internal assessment, theory marks will be proportionately increased to the maximum marks of the paper. The paper setter must include this note in the question paper.

The question paper shall contain 9 questions in total. Question 1 is compulsory, containing 15 short-answer type questions spread over the entire syllabus. Candidate is required to answer any 10 out of these 15, in about 25–30 words each. These shall carry 2 marks each (Total: 20 marks). The remaining paper shall consist of 4 Units. Each Unit will contain two questions with internal choice, with each having a weightage of 15 marks. Candidates must attempt one question from each Unit.

Course Content

Unit I – The Pre-Socratic Philosophers

1. Philosophy, temperament, and the cultural milieu of early Greek thought
2. The Milesian School: Thales, Anaximander, and Anaximenes
3. Pythagoras and the mathematical basis of reality; Heraclitus and the problem of change
4. Eleatics and Pluralists: Parmenides on Being, Zeno's paradoxes, Anaxagoras' *Nous*, and Atomism of Leucippus and Democritus

Unit II – Socrates and Plato

1. Socrates: life and philosophical mission
2. The Socratic method and ethical intellectualism
3. Plato's theory of knowledge and doctrine of Forms
4. Plato's concept of the soul and its metaphysical significance

Unit III – Aristotle

1. Aristotelian theory of categories and the notion of substance
2. Potentiality and actuality
3. Aristotle's conception of causality (four causes)
4. Aristotle's theory of knowledge

Unit IV – Medieval Philosophy: Faith and Reason

1. Philosophy in the medieval period and the synthesis of faith and reason
2. Illuminationism of St. Augustine
3. St. Anselm's ontological argument
4. St. Thomas Aquinas: moderate realism, five proofs for the existence of God, voluntarism and nominalism

Reading List
Essential Readings

Aristotle. (1960). *Metaphysics* (R. Hope, Trans.). Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan Press.
Aquinas, T. (1947).*Summa Theologica* (Fathers of the English Dominican Province, Trans.; Vols. 1–3). New York, NY: Benziger Press.
Burnet, J. (1948). *Early Greek philosophy*. London: Adam & Charles Black.
Plato. (1966). *The works of Plato* (B. Jowett, Trans.). New York, NY: McGraw-Hill.
Zeller, E. (1950). *Outlines of the history of Greek philosophy*. London: Routledge&Kegan Paul.

Suggested Readings
Kenny, A. (2006). *An illustrated brief history of Western philosophy*. Oxford: Blackwell Publishing.
Nicholas, A. (2003). *Discovering Aquinas: An introduction to his life, work, and influence*. Grand Rapids, MI: Eerdmans.
Russell, B. (2005). *A history of Western philosophy*. New Delhi: Routledge.

MAPHILDSC-104: Logic

Course Code: MAPHILDSC-104Credits:4
Level: M.A. Philosophy
Contact Hours: 60
Examination Scheme: Theory: 80 Marks,
Internal Assessment: 20 Marks

Course Objectives

1. To train students in critical and systematic reasoning through the formal study of logic as the science of valid thinking.
2. To introduce the fundamental laws of thought and the logical structure of propositions.
3. To enable students to distinguish clearly between valid and invalid arguments.
4. To develop students' ability to analyse, construct, and evaluate deductive arguments rigorously.
5. To familiarise learners with inductive reasoning and its role in probabilistic thinking.
6. To cultivate logical discipline, precision, and clarity of expression in philosophical reasoning.
7. To help students recognise and avoid common logical fallacies in everyday and academic contexts.
8. To provide training in formal methods such as syllogistic reasoning, symbolic logic, and probability calculus.

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Understand the fundamental principles and laws governing logical thought.
2. Identify, analyse, and evaluate propositions and arguments with precision.
3. Distinguish between valid and invalid deductive arguments and detect logical fallacies.
4. Apply symbolic logic and propositional calculus to formal reasoning problems.
5. Explain the nature and justification of inductive reasoning and probability.
6. Develop disciplined habits of reasoning that minimise fallacious and inconsistent thinking.

Instructions for Paper Setters and Candidates

I. The theory paper shall carry 80 marks, and 20 marks shall be for internal assessment.
II. For private candidates who have not undergone internal assessment, theory marks will be proportionately increased to the maximum marks of the paper. The paper setter must include this note in the question paper.
III. The question paper shall contain 9 questions in total. Question 1 is compulsory, containing 15 short-answer type questions spread over the entire syllabus. Candidate is required to answer any 10 out of these 15, in about 25–30 words each. These shall carry 2 marks each (Total: 20 marks). The remaining paper shall consist of 4 Units. Each Unit

will contain two questions with internal choice, with each having a weightage of 15 marks. Candidates must attempt one question from each Unit.

Course Content

Unit I – Logic, Propositions, and Inference

1. Logic, language, and thought
2. Proposition: definition and classification
3. Square of Opposition and its Boolean modification
4. Inference and argument; validity of arguments; immediate and mediate inference (syllogism)

Unit II – Syllogistic Reasoning

1. Immediate inference: conversion, obversion, contraposition, inversion
2. Inference from relations of opposition between propositions
3. Syllogism: rules or axioms, figures, moods, and fallacies
4. Types and tests of syllogism: enthymeme, sorites, antilogism

Unit III – Symbolic Logic and Propositional Calculus

1. Formalisation of language and symbolisation of propositions
2. Classification of propositions according to structure: simple and compound
3. Classification according to truth-value: tautology, contradiction, contingency
4. Truth-functions, propositional forms, argument forms, rules of inference and rules of replacement

Unit IV – Inductive Logic and Probability

1. Induction as a form of reasoning
2. Formal grounds of induction: law of causation and law of uniformity of nature
3. Paradox of induction and inductive generalisation; role of fair samples
4. Induction and probability: subjective and objective theories; calculus of probability

Essential Readings

Cohen, M. R., & Nagel, E. (1970).*An introduction to logic and scientific method*. New Delhi: Allied Publishers.
Copi, I. M. (1985). *Introduction to logic*. New York, NY: Macmillan.
Copi, I. M. (1985). *Symbolic logic* (5th ed.). New York, NY: Macmillan Collier.

Suggested Readings

Russell, B. (1970). *The principles of mathematics*. London: Allen &Unwin.
Nicod, J. (1970). *Foundations of geometry and induction*. London: Kegan Paul.

MAPHILDSE-105(1): Vedanta

Course Code: MAPHILDSC-105(1)
Credits:4
Level: M.A. Philosophy
Contact Hours:60
Examination Scheme: Theory: 80 Marks,
Internal Assessment: 20 Marks

Objectives

Course Objectives

1. To introduce students to the central doctrines of Vedānta through close engagement with primary Sanskrit texts in reliable English translation.
2. To develop students' ability to read and interpret classical Vedāntic arguments in their textual and philosophical context.
3. To analyse the major schools of Vedānta—Advaita, Viśiṣṭādvaita, and Dvaita—and their key doctrinal differences.
4. To cultivate skills in critical evaluation and comparative study of Vedāntic philosophical positions.
5. To situate Vedānta within the broader debates of Indian philosophy.
6. To highlight the continuing philosophical significance of Vedāntic thought in contemporary discussions.

Learning Outcomes

After completing this paper, students will be able to:

1. Read and interpret key Vedāntic passages with philosophical sensitivity.
2. Analyse major metaphysical, epistemological, and soteriological arguments in Vedānta.
3. Distinguish between Advaita, Viśiṣṭādvaita, and Dvaita positions.
4. Critically evaluate debates on Brahman, self, world, and liberation.
5. Develop textual and comparative skills necessary for advanced research in Indian philosophy.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PAPER-SETTERS AND CANDIDATES

I. The theory paper shall carry 80 marks, and 20 marks shall be for internal assessment.
II. For private candidates who have not undergone internal assessment, theory marks will be proportionately increased to the maximum marks of the paper. The paper setter must include this note in the question paper.
III. The question paper shall contain 9 questions in total. Question 1 is compulsory, containing 15 short-answer type questions spread over the entire syllabus. Candidate is required to answer any 10 out of these 15, in about 25–30 words each. These shall carry 2 marks each (Total: 20 marks). The remaining paper shall consist of 4 Units. Each Unit will contain two questions with internal choice, with each having a weightage of 15 marks. Candidates must attempt one question from each Unit.

Unit I: AdvaitaVedānta — Method and Metaphysics

Textual focus: *Upaniṣads* (selected mahāvākyas), Śaṅkara's*Brahma SūtraBhāṣya* (Introduction/AdhyāsaBhāṣya), and *Vivekacūḍāmaṇi* (selected verses). The unit examines the nature of Brahman, the doctrine of adhyāsa (superimposition), the identity of ātman and Brahman, the distinction between paramārthika and vyāvahārika reality, and the problem of māyā and avidyā.

Unit II: Advaita — Epistemology and Liberation

Textual focus: Śaṅkara's commentaries on selected Upaniṣadic passages and *Vivekacūḍāmaṇi* (selected verses). This unit explores the means of knowledge (pramāṇa) in Advaita, the role of śravaṇa–manana–nididhyāsana, the nature of self-knowledge, the concept of jīvanmukti, and major objections to Advaita realism.

Unit III: Viśiṣṭādvaita — Qualified Non-dualism

Textual focus: Rāmānuja's*ŚrīBhāṣya* (selected passages) and *Vedārthasaṅgraha* (selected passages). The unit analyses the critique of Advaita, the doctrine of qualified non-dualism, the nature of Brahman as qualified by cit and acit, the theory of body–soul relation, the role of bhakti, and the nature of liberation in Viśiṣṭādvaita.

Unit IV: Dvaita — Dualism and Theistic Vedānta

Textual focus: Madhva's*Brahma SūtraBhāṣya* (selected passages) and *Anuvyākhyāna* (selected passages). This unit discusses Madhva's critique of Advaita, the doctrine of pañcabheda (fivefold difference), the nature of God, soul, and world, the epistemological realism of Dvaita, and a comparative reflection on the three major Vedāntic schools.

Essential Readings

1. Radhakrishnan, S. (ed. and trans.). *The Principal Upaniṣads*. HarperCollins / Oxford (relevant passages).
2. Śaṅkara. *Brahma SūtraBhāṣya* (Introduction). Trans. Swami Gambhirananda. AdvaitaAshrama.
3. Śaṅkara. *Vivekacūḍāmaṇi*. Trans. Swami Madhavananda. AdvaitaAshrama.
4. Rāmānuja. *ŚrīBhāṣya* (selected passages). Trans. Swami Vireswarananda. Sri Ramakrishna Math.
5. Rāmānuja. *Vedārthasaṅgraha*. Trans. S. S. Raghavachar.
6. Madhva. *Brahma SūtraBhāṣya* (selected passages). Trans. B. N. K. Sharma.

Suggested Readings

1. Deutsch, Eliot. *Advaita Vedanta: A Philosophical Reconstruction*. University of Hawaii Press.
2. Sharma, B. N. K. *Philosophy of ŚrīMadhvācārya*. MotilalBanarsidass.
3. Srinivasa Chari, S. M. *Philosophy of the VedāntaSūtra*. MunshiramManoharlal.
4. Potter, Karl (ed.). *Encyclopedia of Indian Philosophies, Vol. III: AdvaitaVedānta*. MotilalBanarsidass.
5. Radhakrishnan, S. *Indian Philosophy*, Vol. II. Oxford University Press.

MAPHILDSE-105(2):Plato and Aristotle

Course Code: MAPHILDSC-105(2)

Credits:4
Level:M.A. Philosophy
Contact Hours:60
Examination Scheme: Theory: 80 Marks, Internal Assessment: 20 Marks

Course Objectives

1. To introduce students to the foundational philosophical ideas of Plato and Aristotle through close textual engagement.
2. To develop students' ability to read and interpret classical philosophical texts in a rigorous manner.
3. To cultivate skills in analysing and reconstructing classical philosophical arguments.
4. To situate Platonic and Aristotelian doctrines within the broader context of ancient Greek philosophy.
5. To encourage critical reflection on key themes such as knowledge, reality, ethics, and politics.
6. To highlight the continuing philosophical relevance of Plato and Aristotle in contemporary thought.

Learning Outcomes

After completing this paper, students will be able to:

1. Read and interpret selected passages from Plato and Aristotle in a philosophically informed manner.
2. Analyse central metaphysical, epistemological, ethical, and political arguments in the original texts.
3. Distinguish between Platonic and Aristotelian methodological approaches.
4. Critically evaluate major debates such as Forms versus substance, virtue versus eudaimonia, and knowledge versus opinion.
5. Develop textual and argumentative skills necessary for advanced research in ancient philosophy.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PAPER-SETTERS AND CANDIDATES

I. The theory paper shall carry 80 marks, and 20 marks shall be for internal assessment.

II. For private candidates who have not undergone internal assessment, theory marks will be proportionately increased to the maximum marks of the paper. The paper setter must include this note in the question paper.

III. The question paper shall contain 9 questions in total. Question 1 is compulsory, containing 15 short-answer type questions spread over the entire syllabus. Candidate is required to answer any 10 out of these 15, in about 25–30 words each. These shall carry 2 marks each (Total: 20 marks). The remaining paper shall consist of 4 Units. Each Unit will contain two questions with internal choice, with each having a weightage of 15 marks. Candidates must attempt one question from each Unit.

Unit I: Plato — Method and Metaphysics

Textual focus: *Euthyphro* (selected passages), *Apology* (selected passages), and *Republic*, Books VI–VII (The Sun, Line, and Cave). The unit examines the Socratic method (elenchus), the distinction between knowledge and opinion, the Theory of Forms, the Form of the Good, the problem of appearance and reality, and the philosophical significance of education in the allegory of the cave.

Unit II: Plato — Ethics and Political Philosophy

Textual focus: *Republic*, Books I–IV (selected passages) and *Phaedo* (selected arguments for the immortality of the soul). This unit explores the debate on justice with special reference to Thrasymachus, the tripartite theory of the soul, virtue and moral psychology, the philosopher-king and the ideal state, the major arguments for the immortality of the soul, and the relation between Plato's ethics and metaphysics.

Unit III: Aristotle — Logic, Metaphysics, and Epistemology

Textual focus: *Categories* (selected chapters), *Physics*, Book II (four causes), and *Metaphysics*, Book VII (substance). The unit analyses Aristotle's critique of Plato's Theory of Forms, the notion of substance (ousia) and essence, the doctrine of the four causes, the distinction between potentiality and actuality, Aristotle's method in contrast to Platonic dialectic, and the problem of universals and particulars.

Unit IV: Aristotle — Ethics and Politics

Textual focus: *Nicomachean Ethics*, Books I–II (selected chapters) and *Politics*, Book I (selected chapters). This unit discusses eudaimonia as the highest good, the doctrine of the mean, moral virtue and habituation, practical wisdom (phronesis), Aristotle's conception of the polis and human nature, and a comparative reflection on Aristotelian and Platonic political philosophy.

Essential Readings

1. Plato. *Euthyphro*, *Apology*, *Republic*, *Phaedo* (any standard scholarly translation, preferably Hackett).
2. Aristotle. *Categories*. Trans. J. L. Ackrill. Oxford University Press.
3. Aristotle. *Physics*. Trans. R. P. Hardie and R. K. Gaye.
4. Aristotle. *Metaphysics*. Trans. W. D. Ross. Oxford University Press.
5. Aristotle. *Nicomachean Ethics*. Trans. Terence Irwin or W. D. Ross.
6. Aristotle. *Politics*. Trans. Carnes Lord or H. Rackham.

Suggested Readings

1. Julia Annas. *An Introduction to Plato's Republic*. Oxford University Press.
2. Terence Irwin. *Plato's Ethics*. Oxford University Press.
3. Jonathan Barnes. *Aristotle: A Very Short Introduction*. Oxford University Press.
4. G. E. L. Owen. *Logic, Science and Dialectic*. Cornell University Press.
5. W. D. Ross. *Aristotle*. Routledge.

MAPHILDSC-105 (3): Social and Political Philosophy

Course Code MAPHILDSC-105 (3)
Credits:4
Level: M.A. Philosophy
Contact Hours:60
Examination Scheme: Theory: 80 Marks, Internal Assessment: 20 Marks

Course Objectives

The primary aim of this course is to enable students to **critically analyse central concepts and theoretical frameworks**in social and political philosophy. The course introduces foundational issues such as political obligation, justice, rights, liberty, equality, power, authority, and the common good, situating them within major philosophical debates. By examining these concepts in relation to social institutions and political practices, students gain an understanding of how philosophical reflection informs normative evaluation of social and political life.

A further objective of the course is to cultivate **critical awareness of social change, tradition, and modernity**, and to encourage reflective engagement with the ideals of a good society. The course seeks to develop students' ability to interrogate moral, legal, and political norms while fostering a sense of responsible civic participation. Through sustained conceptual analysis and theoretical comparison, students are prepared to approach contemporary social and political issues with philosophical rigour and ethical sensitivity.

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

5. Critically explain key concepts and theories in social and political philosophy.
6. Analyse philosophical debates concerning political obligation, justice, rights, and social order.
7. Examine the relationship between individuals, society, and the state from a philosophical perspective.
8. Evaluate the ethical dimensions of social change, tradition, and modernity.
9. Apply philosophical reasoning to contemporary social and political issues.
10. Develop a reflective and responsible approach to civic and cosmopolitan citizenship.

Pedagogy of the Course

The course follows a **conceptual and critical pedagogical approach**, combining systematic exposition of theories with close analysis of philosophical texts. Classroom instruction introduces major thinkers and concepts through lectures, followed by guided discussions that clarify arguments and highlight points of disagreement. Emphasis is placed on conceptual precision and normative reasoning, enabling students to understand the philosophical foundations of social and political life.

In addition, the pedagogy encourages **reflective engagement and critical dialogue** through short written responses, seminar discussions, and internal assessments. Students are encouraged to relate philosophical theories to concrete social and political contexts, fostering an active sense of inquiry and civic responsibility. This approach ensures that learners develop both theoretical understanding and the ability to critically assess contemporary social realities

Instructions for Paper Setters and Candidates

I. The theory paper shall carry 80 marks, and 20 marks shall be for internal assessment.
II. For private candidates who have not undergone internal assessment, theory marks will be proportionately increased to the maximum marks of the paper. The paper setter must include this note in the question paper.
III. The question paper shall contain 9 questions in total. Question 1 is compulsory, containing 15 short-answer type questions spread over the entire syllabus. Candidate is required to answer any 10 out of these 15, in about 25–30 words each. These shall carry 2 marks each (Total: 20 marks). The remaining paper shall consist of 4 Units. Each Unit will contain two questions with internal choice, with each having a weightage of 15 marks. Candidates must attempt one question from each Unit.

Course Content

Unit I – Nature and Scope of Social and Political Philosophy

11. Nature and scope of social and political philosophy
12. Distinction and relation between the natural and the social realms
13. Difference between science and philosophy
14. Relation between sociology, political science, and social and political philosophy

Unit II – Core Concepts and Theories

15. Civil society and social contract
16. Sovereignty; consent, dissent, and resistance
17. Power and authority; political obligation

18. Common good, moral obligation, equality, liberty, fraternity, rights, justice, ideology, and utopia

Unit III – Individual, Society, and State

19. Individual and smaller social groups: family, caste, community
20. Individual and larger collectivities: nation and humanity
21. Relation between individual and society
22. Relation between individual and state

Unit IV – Methods in Social and Political Philosophy

23. Philosophical methods in social and political philosophy
24. Normative, critical, and interpretive approaches
25. Relation between social and political philosophy and philosophy of social sciences
26. Contemporary methodological debates

Reading List

Essential Readings

Sen, Amartya. (2002). *Development as freedom*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Taylor, Charles. (1992). *Sources of the self: The making of the modern identity*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Mouffe, Chantal. (2000). *The democratic paradox*. London: Verso.

Krishna, Daya. (1965). *Considerations towards the theory of social change*. New Delhi: W. R. Chambers.

Krishna, Daya. (1993). *Social philosophy: Past and future*. Shimla: Indian Institute of Advanced Study.

Fanon, Frantz. (2002). *The wretched of the earth*. London: Penguin.

Gandhi, M. K. (2004). *Hind Swaraj*. Ahmedabad: Navajivan Publishing House.

Habermas, Jürgen. (1990). *The philosophical discourse of modernity: Twelve lectures*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.

Marx, Karl. (1967). *Economic and philosophic manuscripts*. Moscow: Progress Publishers.

Foucault, Michel. (2002). *The archaeology of knowledge*. London: Routledge.

Plato. (1992). *Republic*. Indianapolis, IN: Hackett Publishing.

Sartre, Jean-Paul.(1973). *Revolution and the intellectual*. London: Calder & Boyars.

Guru, G., &Sarukkai, S. (2012). *The cracked mirror: An Indian debate on experience and theory*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.

Suggested Readings

Quinton, A. (Ed.). (2004). *Political philosophy*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

King, P., &McGilvicy, J. (1975).*Political and social philosophy: Traditional and contemporary readings*. New York, NY: McGraw-Hill.

Kymlicka, W. (2005).*Contemporary political philosophy*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

MAPHILDSC-105(4): Philosophy of Science (Part 1)

Course Code: MAPHILDSC-105(4)
Credits:4
Contact Hours:60
Examination Scheme: Theory: 80 Marks, Internal Assessment: 20 Marks

1. To provide a systematic and balanced introduction to the philosophy of science with special reference to the natural sciences.
2. To examine the processes through which scientific knowledge is generated, justified, revised, and replaced.
3. To develop an understanding of science as a dynamic, historically situated human enterprise rather than a mere collection of facts.
4. To analyse major philosophical interpretations of scientific progress, explanation, and theory change.
5. To cultivate the ability to distinguish between scientific practice, philosophical methodology, and epistemological reflection.
6. To familiarise students with key debates concerning empiricism, realism, positivism, and scientific revolutions.
7. To strengthen students' capacity for critical analysis of the conceptual foundations of scientific inquiry.
8. To enable reflective understanding of scientific reasoning and the growth of knowledge across disciplines.

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Explain major philosophical approaches to understanding scientific knowledge.
2. Analyse the concept of scientific progress and theory change.
3. Distinguish between observation, theory, and interpretation in scientific inquiry.
4. Critically evaluate debates between empiricism, realism, and positivism.
5. Understand the role of inference, explanation, and justification in science.
6. Reflect on the relationship between scientific methodology and philosophical analysis.

Pedagogy of the Course

The course follows a conceptual and debate-oriented pedagogical approach, combining lectures with close discussion of major philosophical positions in the philosophy of science. Classroom teaching introduces key theories and thinkers, followed by structured discussions that examine their assumptions, strengths, and limitations. Emphasis is placed on understanding scientific examples that illustrate philosophical problems such as theory change, explanation, and confirmation.

In addition, the pedagogy encourages critical engagement and comparative analysis through internal assessments, short written responses, and seminar-style discussions. Students are guided

to relate philosophical debates to concrete scientific practices, fostering an appreciation of the interaction between science and philosophy. This approach ensures that learners develop both theoretical understanding and critical reasoning skills applicable across disciplines.

Instructions for Paper Setters and Candidates

I. The theory paper shall carry 80 marks, and 20 marks shall be for internal assessment.
II. For private candidates who have not undergone internal assessment, theory marks will be proportionately increased to the maximum marks of the paper. The paper setter must include this note in the question paper.
III. The question paper shall contain 9 questions in total. Question 1 is compulsory, containing 15 short-answer type questions spread over the entire syllabus. Candidate is required to answer any 10 out of these 15, in about 25–30 words each. These shall carry 2 marks each (Total: 20 marks). The remaining paper shall consist of 4 Units. Each Unit will contain two questions with internal choice, with each having a weightage of 15 marks. Candidates must attempt one question from each Unit.

Course Content

Unit I – Kuhn and the Structure of Scientific Knowledge

5. Emergence of philosophy of science as a discipline
6. Thomas Kuhn's philosophy of science
7. Paradigms and normal science
8. Incommensurability and theory choice

Unit II – Scientific Change and Theory-Ladenness

9. Scientific revolutions and discontinuity
10. Observation and theory
11. Role of anomalies and crisis
12. Rationality and progress in science

Unit III – Empiricism and Scientific Realism

13. Classical empiricism and its limitations
14. Logical empiricism and confirmation

15. Scientific realism and anti-realism
16. Explanation, laws, and models in science

Unit IV – Positivism and Scientific Inference

17. Positivism and verification
18. Induction and inference in science
19. Deductive–nomological and inductive–statistical models
20. Critiques of positivism and methodological pluralism

Reading List

Essential Readings

Hempel, C. G. (1966). *Philosophy of natural science*. Englewood Cliffs, NJ: Prentice Hall.

Kuhn, T. S. (1962). *The structure of scientific revolutions*. Chicago, IL: University of Chicago Press.

Lakatos, I., & Musgrave, A. (Eds.).(1970). *Criticism and the growth of knowledge*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Suggested Readings

Feyerabend, P. (1975). *Against method*. London: New Left Books.

Nagel, E. (1961). *The structure of science*. New York, NY: Harcourt, Brace & World.

Popper, K. (1959). *The logic of scientific discovery*. London: Hutchinson.